

Feedback from Week One



THE LONDON SCHOOL
OF ECONOMICS AND
POLITICAL SCIENCE ■

What we did in Week One



- Essay questions
- Thesis statements
- Introductions
- Conclusions

Essay question



Last year, 3.96 billion people used social media, which is more than half the world's population. Is this cause for concern?

You could have answered the question in different ways.

1. **With a strong position:** “Yes, the use of social media is a cause for concern”, or “No, the use of social media is not a cause for concern”.
2. **With a more nuanced position:** “To some extent...”; “In some ways...”; “It depends...”

Thesis statements



Most essays had thesis statements but they often lacked specificity. Compare:

- Social media has both positive and negative impacts. (VAGUE)
- While social media use offers valuable opportunities for communication, education, and community building, it also contributes to issues such as mental health decline, misinformation, and reduced attention spans. (SPECIFIC)

Take a look at your thesis statement. Can you make it more specific?

LSE uses “Turnitin” which checks essays for potential plagiarism (see below).

On the one hand, we do admit the popularity of social media can benefit its users.

Esteban (2019) argues that ³most of us would agree that digital social media platforms can make our lives easier in many ways - opening doors to new information, connecting us with people who are far away, and helping us to be more flexible with work.

According to ⁵Kross (2021,55-66), ⁴a wide range of studies indicate that social media provide feedback that satisfies people’s socioemotional and cognitive needs. In some cases, the support benefits that people derive from social media outweigh those they obtain in the offline world.

- Look at the Turnitin report for your essay. What is your “similarity score”?
- Look at the ‘match overview’. Has any text been highlighted? If so, do you need to improve your paraphrasing skills?



Essay feedback



- Your teachers have read your essays and given you feedback on “strengths” and “areas for improvement”.
- Read your feedback and let your teacher know if you have any questions.

There is no one approach to the use of generative AI across LSE. The School allows different approaches to be taken by different academic departments and course convenors. Within the School's guidance, there are three positions:

Position 1: No authorised use of generative AI in assessment.

Position 2: Limited authorised use of generative AI in assessment

Position 3: Full authorised use of generative AI in assessment.

Artificial intelligence



When you begin your degree, you will need to ensure that you are familiar with the AI policy on your courses.

If you would like to develop your AI literacy, take a look at this Moodle course: [Course: Generative AI: Developing your AI Literacy | Moodle](#)



Language feedback



In today's class, we would like you to use AI to get more feedback on how to improve the language in your essay.

Open the **Reading into Writing AI Feedback Workbook** on Moodle and follow the instructions. Make sure you read the Golden Rules about using AI.

You can choose which tool you would like to use e.g. Copilot, Claude, ChatGPT, Deepseek...

Important: AI is a tool to support your learning. It does not replace your thinking or your teacher.

Once you have completed the workbook,
discuss:



1. Did you find the feedback useful?
2. What, if anything, have you learned?
3. Was there anything that surprised you?



Last week, we hadn't discussed how to 'synthesise' literature in your writing. In other words, how to combine multiple sources to create a coherent new whole.

How did you do in this area?

- Do you cite all three of the extracts?
- How many citations do you have in each paragraph?
- Do you show relationships between the extracts – e.g. do you compare and contrast them or draw other links?

Looking forward



What are your aims for this week? What areas do you want to improve?

